

Working Review: Document Update Process

My perspective on how this should support the collaboration and co-development process

My overall read: this is more than a file-management note. It is beginning to define how our collaboration becomes auditable, how changes become official, and how shared ideas are recorded over time.

1. What I Think This Gets Right

The master / snapshot distinction is clean. The Word file is clearly the editable master and the PDF is only the current recorded snapshot. That avoids multiple versions floating around and makes it obvious which file controls if anything is out of sync.

The human decision comes before the AI production step. The process says Tim and Gigi discuss and agree on a change first. Only after that does the language get drafted, applied, logged, and regenerated. I like that because it keeps Claude in a drafting and production role rather than making it the authority on what becomes part of the collaboration.

The Change Log is a good discipline. Having a record of what changed, when, and who agreed to it is much better than trying to reconstruct decisions months later by comparing files.

Separating document changes from methodology changes is important. The note correctly distinguishes updates to the collaboration document from changes to the underlying methodology. I think we should protect that separation as the project gets more complex.

2. Where I Would Tighten the Process

Agreement needs two levels

The phrase “Tim and Gigi discuss a change and agree on it” is directionally right, but I think we need to distinguish between agreeing with an idea and approving the exact wording that enters the document of record.

Concept Agreement	Text Approval
We agree with the direction or principle.	We both approve the exact language that becomes part of the record.

The Change Log should capture the reason, not just the change

I would add a “Why” field. Six months from now, knowing why something changed may be as important as knowing what changed. A simple entry could read:

9/17/26 - Human Agency - Added readiness gate - Pressure test exposed accountability without measurable agency - Agreed by Tim + Gigi.

Origin and approval should not be treated as the same thing

An idea can originate with one person, be refined together, and then be formally adopted by both. Those are three different facts. I think the co-development record should preserve that lineage instead of collapsing everything into “approved by both.”

Suggested principle: Formal adoption should not erase attribution.

We need a simple status system

Not every concept is at the same level of maturity. A lightweight status system would keep us from treating an early idea as if it were already settled: Proposed; Under Review; Concept Agreed; Text Approved; Adopted; Retired / Superseded.

There should be an explicit disagreement path

The current process assumes agreement. I would add one simple rule: if we do not agree, the item remains Proposed or Under Review and does not enter the document of record.

3. How I Would Strengthen the Co-Development Principles Log

Section 17 may become much more important than it looks today. If it tracks ideas that we formally review and adopt together, it can become the intellectual lineage of the collaboration - not just another version log.

Principle name: What we are calling the idea.

Origin / originator: Where the idea first came from.

Summary: What the principle actually means.

Date introduced: When it first entered the work.

Date adopted: When both of us formally approved it.

Status: Proposed, under review, adopted, etc.

Contributors: Who materially shaped or refined it.

Framework location: Where the principle now appears or is used.

4. How I See Claude's Role

I am comfortable with Claude drafting, reconciling, formatting, maintaining the log, and regenerating the Word/PDF pair. I would just make one boundary explicit in the process:

Claude can help produce and maintain the record, but no substantive change becomes part of the document of record until Tim and Gigi approve it.

5. Three Different Records We Should Keep Separate

As the project grows, I think we are really managing three different histories. Keeping them separate will make the collaboration much easier to understand later.

Collaboration Governance: How Tim and Gigi work together, approve changes, and maintain the working agreement.

Methodology Evolution: Changes to HITL, working relationships, readiness, criticality, role analysis, and the underlying framework.

Co-Developed Principles: Ideas that are formally adopted, including origin, contributors, and where they are used.

6. The Three Questions I Think the Process Should Always Answer

What changed? Version control.

Who agreed to it? Governance.

Where did the idea come from? Intellectual lineage.

The current note already handles the first two reasonably well. The third - intellectual lineage - is the area I would strengthen most.

7. My Recommended Revisions

- Distinguish Concept Agreement from final Text Approval.
- Add a “Why” field to the Change Log.
- Add origin / attribution fields to the Co-Development Principles Log.
- Use a simple status system so early ideas are not mistaken for adopted principles.
- Add a rule for unresolved disagreements.
- Clarify that Claude is a drafting / production assistant, not the approval authority.
- Keep collaboration governance, methodology changes, and co-developed principles in separate records.

8. My Bottom Line

I think the process note is a strong foundation. I would not overcomplicate it. The main opportunity is to make sure it protects more than file accuracy. It should also protect the integrity of the collaboration: what we agreed to, why we agreed to it, and how an idea moved from one person's thinking into something we formally adopted together.

This should become a co-development governance process, not just a document-update procedure.

Source basis: Document Update Process - How This Document Stays Current, September 2026. This review reflects my interpretation and recommended refinements; it does not alter the source document.